

.Scora

Code Luck

Build Your Lucky Future

Research & Market Validation

Personas, evidence signals, MVP boundaries & validation plan

1. Research Summary & Product Thesis

Scora is a technical verification and talent discovery platform built for developers and the people who hire them. The product responds to a clear market gap: code can now be generated quickly with AI, but hiring teams still need evidence that a developer understands, explains, secures, and maintains the code they deliver.

Research thesis: verified technical evidence can become a durable reputation layer that reduces hiring uncertainty without treating AI assistance as a violation.

2. Problem Signals

- Developers struggle to prove real comprehension beyond resumes, portfolios, and inconsistent star ratings.
- Clients and hiring teams risk paying for unmaintainable or insecure code they cannot evaluate before delivery.
- Traditional assessments often reward memorization or speed rather than maintainability, security, and explanation.
- Static AI detectors create false positives; behavioral signals should be used as supporting evidence, not absolute proof.

3. Personas & Jobs-to-be-Done

Persona	Job to be done	Main pain	Validation trigger
Software developer	Prove technical comprehension and earn better opportunities.	Resume filtering, low-signal ratings, repeated interviews.	Passport, Trust Score, verified skills.
Individual client	Hire a developer whose code is secure and maintainable.	Hidden AI copy-paste and technical debt.	Passport audit view and skill breakdown.
Enterprise hiring team	Shortlist verified technical talent at scale.	Manual interviews, inflated resumes, cheating risk.	Search directory, telemetry, AST quality report.

4. Value Proposition & Trust Principles

- AI-tool agnostic: developers may use AI, but remain accountable for the result.
- Comprehension over output speed: evaluate structure, maintainability, duplication, and security.
- Evidence over claims: combine challenge performance, code quality, and behavioral signals.
- Transparent reputation: show what was verified, when it was verified, and which signals affected the result.

Scora's moat is not AI detection. It is a repeatable evidence system that makes technical trust visible to both sides of the marketplace.

5. MVP Boundary

MVP includes	Deferred after MVP
Signup/login, developer profile, dynamic assessment, browser coding environment, sandbox execution, AST quality analysis, trust telemetry, Trust Score/SP calculation, Developer Passport, client directory, filters, passport view, contact form.	Live voice interviewer, GitHub auto-sync, peer-review appeals, project milestones, escrow, ATS/SSO integrations, custom enterprise assessment builder.

6. Business Model Signals

Segment	Core value	Monetization direction
Developers	Credibility, verified skills, priority matching.	Free entry; paid verification and Pro features.
Clients	Faster discovery and lower hiring risk.	Freemium discovery; paid contact and advanced filters.
Companies	High-trust candidate pipeline and API verification.	B2B SaaS subscription and assessment API.

7. Research-Backed Success Metrics

Metric	Formula	MVP target
Assessment completion	Completed assessments / started assessments	> 75%
Passport activation	Verified passports / registrations	> 60%
False-positive flag rate	Incorrect flags / telemetry audits	< 3%
Search-to-contact	Outreach messages / passport views	> 12.5%
Evaluation latency	Submission to AST report	< 4.5 seconds

8. Risks & Research Questions

- Will developers trust telemetry if the product clearly explains what is tracked and why?
- Will clients act on a Passport if the score is understandable and the evidence is inspectable?
- Can the first assessment library produce enough signal without creating excessive onboarding friction?
- Which paid moment converts best: verification, advanced discovery, or company workflow?
- How do we keep the product useful for individuals while building toward B2B2C revenue?

9. Evidence Base

The supplied scope document references Pendo feature adoption research, Standish/CHAOS scope research, GitClear code-quality analysis, Stanford/Purdue AI-assisted coding studies, CISQ software-quality cost research, JetBrains developer surveys, W3C Verifiable Credentials, IEEE complexity standards, and OWASP security guidance. These sources should be validated and linked in the final research appendix before public release.